

Ever since he fought off an extraterrestrial invasion with the Avengers in New York, Tony has worried about his ability to protect not just humanity, but also Pepper and the things most dear to him. He's been working, building, and tinkering in his workshop under his mansion—in part because he's Tony Stark and that's what he does, but also as a way to handle the stress and anxiety that come along with his new self-awareness and responsibility. He's thrown himself into his work.

"There's a funny scene with Pepper Potts, played by Gwyneth Paltrow, where Tony's in his suit and she says, 'What is that, Mark VIII or VIX?' And he looks down at his arm and it's Mark XLII and he says, 'Oh, yeah,'" says Louis D'Esposito, Executive Producer and Co-President of Marvel Studios.

And all these new suits must be stored somewhere. "Tony builds a subbasement to the basement," D'Esposito continues. "And it's actually a wine room, and it's circular—I don't know how many bottles are there—but there's a metal cylinder in the middle."

That metal cylinder holds 30-40 new armors, safe from view and attack. That turns out to be a good thing later, after Tony—who for all his brilliance is not known for his humility—angrily challenges his enemies on international television, daring them to come to his Malibu house and get him. It doesn't occur to him that someone might actually have the firepower to do it.

Tony's public dare goes wrong, and then he doesn't just stumble. He loses his mansion—home to his workshop, his Iron Man suits, his partner Pepper Potts, and his most valuable, top-secret technology.

But he still has his wine cellar.



Art by Rob McKinnon.